Q+A

Masters of Maximalism

Designers Abu Jani and Sandeep Khosla on their return to the ramp, their take on couture, and more



Photograph by GURI SEKHON

Q. You had a seven-year hiatus from the ramp before the recent India Couture Week...

We usually prefer to exhibit independently but were keen on exhibiting our young labels, Asal by Abu Sandeep and Mard by Abu Sandeep, in the capital, so that it debuts with the new wedding wear collection. Couture Week seemed like the perfect platform for this.

Q. The showcase featured original music and even a stand-up comic. Is this a new trend?

It's about giving the audience a spectacular experience. We are passionate about music, dance and showcasing young and rising talent. As far as stand-up comedy goes, Sumukhi Suresh is very talented. She was the perfect choice to open the show and walk the ramp for us.

Q. And Radhika Merchant's much-talked-about bridal attire.

Radhika had dreamt of an ensemble that broke the borders of fashion. We commissioned artist Jayasri Burman to create a 12-panelled painting with human figures sitting among pink-hued clouds with flora and fauna. Our atelier then took over to embroider the lehenga in lavish zardozi and sequins.

Q. What about the current state of Indian fashion?

India has a huge group of pret-a-porter designers making casual and formal wear now. We too have a label, Gulabo by Abu Sandeep, that offers casual and formal wear. Our Asal and AJSK labels also create non-bridal ranges for formal, red carpet and occasion wear. The industry can only grow from here.

–with Geetika Sachdev